Future forms

Objective: Choose the right future form (will, be going to, present continuous, future continuous, future perfect) to make predictions and talk about plans.

In two lines: English has no single future tense. The form we choose depends on whether we predict, decide, plan, or describe an action in progress or completed by a future time.

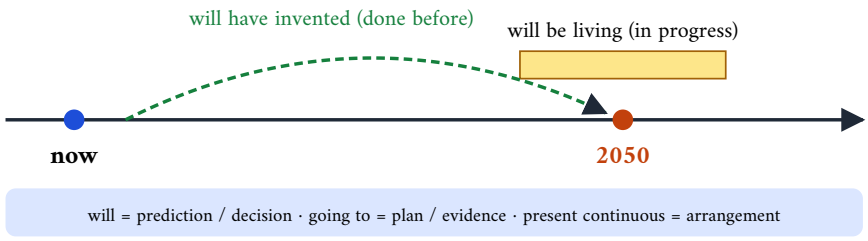


Figure 1: A timeline showing the main future forms and what each one expresses.

🔵 Rules and concepts

1. **will + base verb:** predictions based on opinion, and decisions made at the moment of speaking: *Robots will do housework.*
2. **be going to:** intentions and predictions based on present evidence: *Look at the clouds! It's going to rain.*
3. **Present continuous:** fixed arrangements: *We are visiting the science museum on Sunday.*
4. **Future continuous** (will be + V-ing): an action in progress at a future time: *This time next year, I will be studying physics.*
5. **Future perfect** (will have + past participle): an action completed before a future time, often with *by*: *By 2050, scientists will have found new energy sources.*
6. After **when, as soon as, before, until** we use the present, not *will*.

🟢 Examples

1. Complete: By the end of this century, people (build) cities on the Moon. **Answer:** will have built. **Explanation:** completed before a future time (*by*).
2. Complete: At 8 tomorrow, we (watch) the documentary. **Answer:** will be watching. **Explanation:** in progress at a precise future moment.
3. Correct: I will call you when I will arrive. **Answer:** I will call you when I arrive.

🟠 Common BAC mistakes

- Using *will* after time conjunctions (*when, as soon as*).
- Forgetting *be* in *going to*: *I going to travel.*
- Confusing future continuous and future perfect when the sentence contains *by*.
- Writing *will have finish* instead of the past participle *finished.*

🟡 Quick review

- will: prediction or quick decision.
- going to: plan or evidence now.
- will be + V-ing: in progress then.
- will have + V3: finished by then.
- Time clauses take the present simple.

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